

141, 801, 986, 1247, 1249, 1726, 1752, 1876, 2626 (this picture is probably due to the nature of the variant and does not reflect a dependency); for 1 Peter 1:23 and 4:11 there are none.

Comment: the glaring feature of this second group is that it is limited to one book. Another ‘glare’ is the dominance of M Lavras—almost half of the total (but there are some M Lavras MSS that are in neither group). The probability that this second group could represent the archetype is also negligible.

As with $\epsilon\chi\eta$ in James 2:14, the omission of $\tau\omicron\upsilon$ in 1 Peter 4:2 is attested by 36 MSS, over 40% of the family. Since there is little doubt that the archetype read the article, how to account for the high attestation for the omission? I suppose it was pressure from the Byzantine bulk, almost 80% here. In the context one would expect the article, that I consider to be correct.

We now come to the only real ‘problem’ for determining the archetypal form of the family in the General Epistles—1 John 1:6 (at the outset I mentioned fourteen splits, of which I have only dealt with thirteen). This is the only place in the General Epistles where the archetypal form is preserved in a minority of the extant representatives, at least as I see it. The grand point at issue could be a case of dittography. The verb ‘say’ is properly Subjunctive, being controlled by $\epsilon\alpha\nu$, but the verbs ‘have’ and ‘walk’ are part of a statement and are properly Indicative—only if we are in fact walking in darkness do we become liars for claiming to be in fellowship. So $\pi\epsilon\rho\iota\pi\alpha\tau\omicron\upsilon\mu\epsilon\nu$ is correct. But to return to the MSS, we observe a curious circumstance: the roster that reads the Subjunctive is made up of precisely the two sub-groups, 2255 being the only outsider (a probable dittography); all the other MSS that do not participate in either sub-group read the Indicative, and they have a very good geographical distribution. Consider:

18	Constantinople	1364	35	Paris	XI
141	Vatican	XIII	204	Bologna	XIII
386	Vatican	XIV	801	Athens	XV
824	Grottaferrata	XIV	1100	Dionysiu	1376
1101	Dionysiu	1660	1250	Sinai	XV
1636	M Lavras	XV	1704	Kutlumusiu	1541
1725	Vatopediu	1367	1726	Vatopediu	XIV
1732	M Lavras	1384	1733	M Lavras	XIV
1754	Panteleimonos	XII	1761	Athens	XIV
1858	Konstamonitu	XIII	1865	Philotheu	XIII
1876	Sinai	XV	1897	Jerusalem	XII
2080	Patmos	XIV	2221	Sparta	1432